MODULE 12

Creativity & Inspiration

Create bounded musical ideas with a practical purpose.





Your idea:



LISTEN + REST BEFORE THE REPLY

Four-Note Composer

Call-and-Response Maker

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Choose one goal. Try one illustrated task. Carry what works into your music.

ACTIVITY III

Four-Note Composer

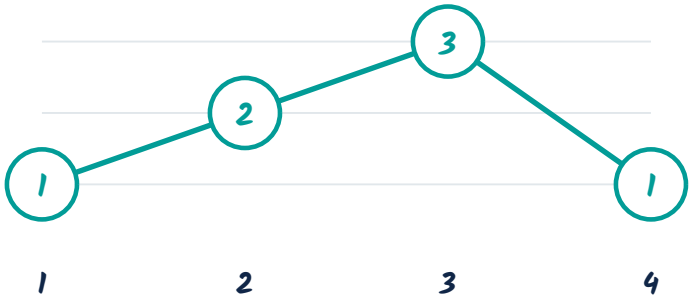
Creativity & Inspiration

7 minutes / Four beats and notes 1, 2, and 3.

Create a short melody within a clear musical boundary.



One note per beat / notes 1, 2 and 3



Your idea:

One original example: four beats, one note per beat, using only notes 1, 2 and 3.

1. Model a four-beat phrase using only the three notes, with one note per beat.
2. Pairs invent a different phrase, choosing a comfortable starting pitch and allowing a rest.
3. Share voluntarily, echo the phrase, and describe its shape rather than ranking it.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The created phrase fits four beats and uses the agreed note set.

COMMON TRAP

Using more notes or beats than the agreed boundary.

MAKE IT WORK

Speak note numbers or use hand signs instead of singing alone.

ACTIVITY 112

Rhythm Name Mosaic

Creativity & Inspiration

7 minutes / Name cards or voluntary spoken names.

Build an original group rhythm from spoken names.

SAM	MAYA	LEO
Sam	Ma ya	Le o

1	2	3	4
Sam	Ma-ya	Le-o	II REST

Original name-card example, used with permission. Hear syllables over a repeating beat.

1. Choose three names with permission and speak their natural syllable rhythms.
2. Arrange them across a short repeating pulse, inserting a rest where needed.
3. Perform the combined rhythm together, then replace names with neutral syllables while keeping its shape.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The mosaic has a repeatable rhythm and clear rests.

COMMON TRAP

Forcing someone to offer a personal name.

MAKE IT WORK

Use favourite food or place names instead of personal names.

ACTIVITY 113

Lyric Seed Workshop

Creativity & Inspiration

8 minutes / Theme cards and paper.

Write a brief original lyric that fits a simple rhythm.

THEME: BELONGING

To-geth-er we sing here

SIX SYLLABLES OVER FOUR BEATS

To-ge	ther-we	sing	here
1	2	3	4

An original six-syllable line can begin with two syllables on beats 1 and 2.

1. Choose a shared theme such as belonging and collect a few concrete words.
2. Write a line of six to eight syllables, checking that its meaning is clear when spoken.
3. Speak it over four beats and revise awkward words before trying a gentle melody.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The lyric can be spoken naturally within the chosen pulse.

COMMON TRAP

Fitting awkward words before speaking the line naturally.

MAKE IT WORK

Use a sentence starter such as 'Together we...' and work as one group.

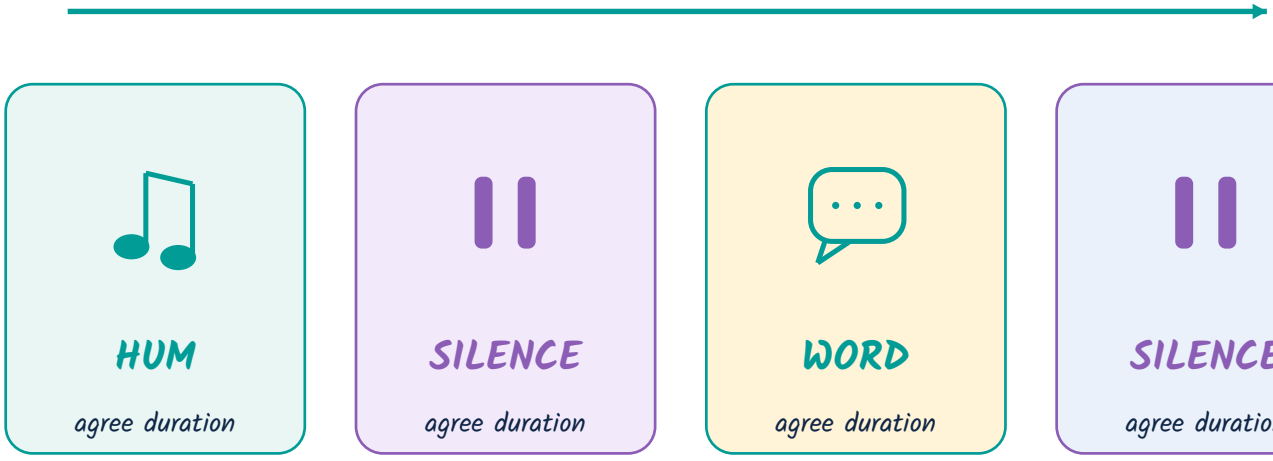
ACTIVITY 114

Sound and Silence Sculpture

Creativity & Inspiration

7 minutes / A visible four-box plan.

Make a short structured piece using sound and intentional rests.



Four agreed durations make a repeatable form. Silence has a deliberate place.

1. *Label four boxes: hum, silence, spoken word, silence; agree a comfortable duration for each.*
2. *Perform the plan once with a clear cue at every boundary.*
3. *Let groups change one box and explain how the silence changes the musical effect.*

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The silences are deliberate and the form can be repeated.

COMMON TRAP

Treating silent boxes as unplanned gaps.

MAKE IT WORK

Use gestures or gentle tapping instead of pitched sound.

ACTIVITY IIS

Call-and-Response Maker

Creativity & Inspiration

8 minutes / A two-bar framework.

Invent a response that clearly answers a short musical call.



LISTEN + REST BEFORE THE REPLY

A short original call and one possible reply. Listen, rest, then answer.

1

The director offers a short original call on notes 1-2-3; the group listens first.

2

Pairs create a reply using 3-2-1 or another easy three-note shape with matching length.

3

Perform the call and selected replies with a rest between turns, keeping participation voluntary.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The response fits the space and relates audibly to the call.

COMMON TRAP

Answering before hearing the complete call.

MAKE IT WORK

Create a spoken reply before setting it to notes.

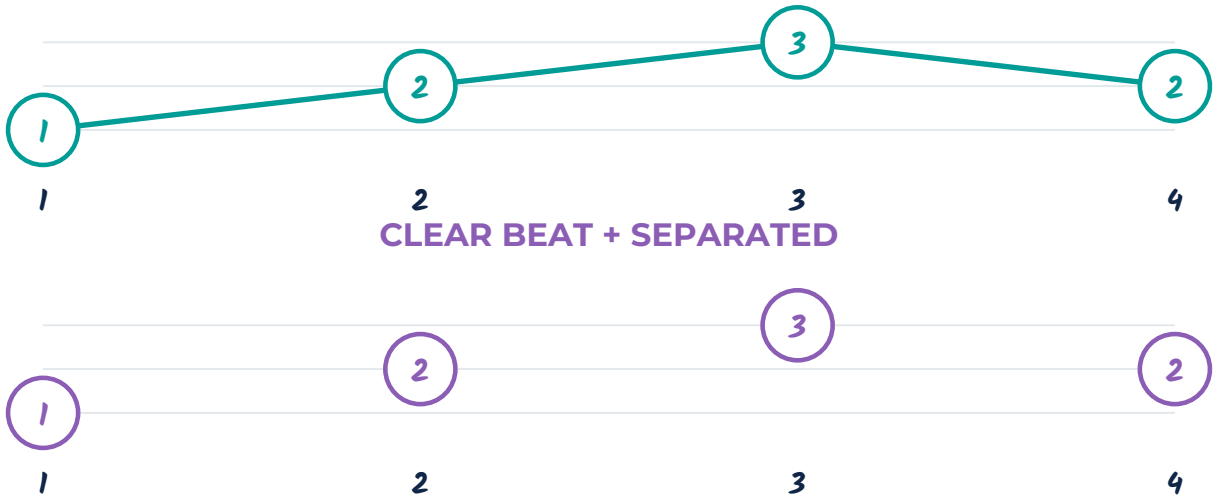
ACTIVITY 116

Style Choice Laboratory

Creativity & Inspiration

8 minutes / A short original or licensed phrase.

Explore how interpretation changes when musical features change.



Change articulation and pulse deliberately; choose what supports the text.

1. *Sing the phrase once with connected notes and a gentle, flowing pulse.*
2. *Repeat with lighter separated articulation and a clearer beat, without imitating a cultural style you have not studied.*
3. *Choose the features that best support the text and name the actual changes made.*

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Singers describe concrete musical choices instead of relying on stereotypes.

COMMON TRAP

Naming a cultural style instead of musical features.

MAKE IT WORK

Work in speech and rhythm if the melodic version is too demanding.

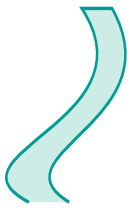
ACTIVITY 117

Rehearsal Inspiration Cards

Creativity & Inspiration

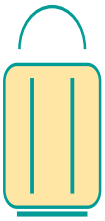
7 minutes / Cards reading river, lantern, bridge, and sunrise.

Turn a creative image into a practical musical experiment.



RIVER

flow



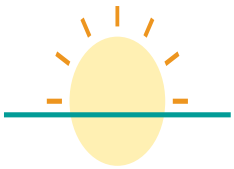
LANTERN

clarity



BRIDGE

connection



SUNRISE

growth

An image must serve the actual lyric

Turn one image into a musical experiment, then judge whether it helps the real phrase.

1. *Pick a card and connect its image to a specific feature: flow, clarity, connection, or gradual growth.*
2. *Sing one phrase using that feature, staying within comfortable vocal limits.*
3. *Ask whether it improved the actual music; keep useful choices and discard distracting ones.*

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The image produces an audible, relevant adjustment.

COMMON TRAP

Keeping a creative image even when it distracts.

MAKE IT WORK

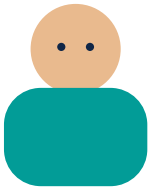
Read the images aloud or let the whole choir choose one card.

Community Dedication Line

Creativity & Inspiration

8 minutes / The next performance's purpose.

Create a short spoken or sung introduction that suits the audience.



"We are glad to share this song with you."



WELCOME / OPENING CUE

An original welcoming example: "We are glad to share this song with you." Keep participation voluntary.

1. Discuss who will listen and what the song can appropriately offer them, avoiding assumptions about beliefs.
2. Write one clear welcoming sentence and test it aloud for length and tone.
3. Choose a speaker or group response voluntarily and rehearse the sentence into the opening cue.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The introduction is concise, respectful, and leads smoothly into the music.

COMMON TRAP

Writing a long introduction that delays the opening.

MAKE IT WORK

Keep the dedication spoken and use inclusive language suited to the event.

ACTIVITY 119

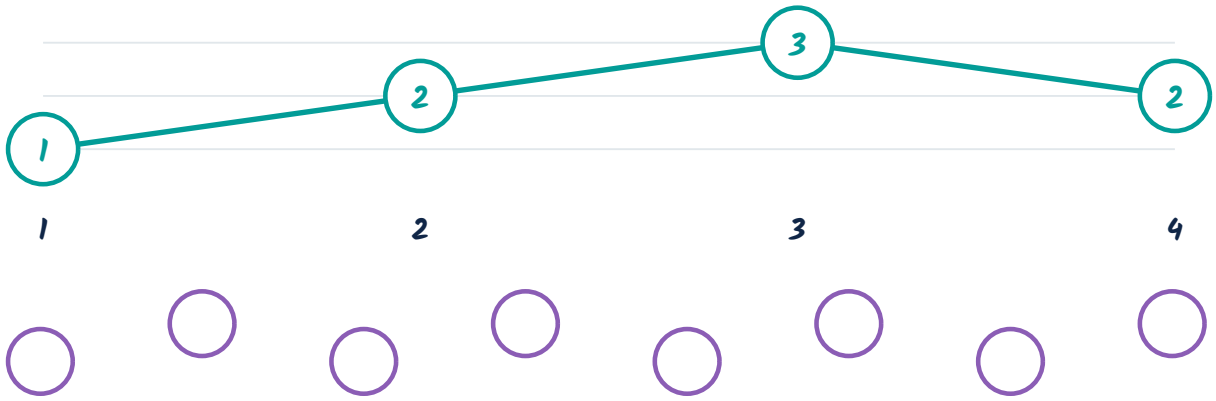
Arrange a Gentle Ostinato

Creativity & Inspiration

8 minutes / An original melody or music you have permission to arrange.

Support a melody with a short repeating pattern.

MELODY: keep the text clear



A gentle two-note pattern below the melody

Illustrative contour only: choose actual accompaniment notes that fit your melody's harmony.

1. Choose a two-note pattern that fits the melody's harmony and comfortable voice ranges.
2. Practise it quietly for four beats, then rest while another group tries the melody.
3. Combine them briefly and reduce the ostinato's volume if it hides the text; check any clashes with the score.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The repeated part supports the melody without overpowering it.

COMMON TRAP

Choosing accompaniment notes without checking harmony.

MAKE IT WORK

Use a rhythmic spoken pattern if harmonic choices are uncertain.

ACTIVITY 120

Choir's Own Closing Ritual

Creativity & Inspiration

8 minutes / Two minutes for group planning.

Create a repeatable musical ending that reflects the ensemble.

"Together, we leave with hope."



One original closing example: a shared word, a brief response, then a clear ending.

1. Collect one word that describes how the choir wants to leave rehearsal, such as grounded or connected.
2. Build a brief original spoken line and a comfortable two-note response around the chosen word.
3. Agree the cue, duration, and option to listen; use the ritual once and review whether it feels welcoming.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The ritual is short, repeatable, and comfortable for the whole group.

COMMON TRAP

Making a closing ritual compulsory for every voice.

MAKE IT WORK

Keep the ritual entirely spoken and allow any singer to pass.